Michael Susz

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Senior Front-End Developer • Design Systems & Accessibility

Built and led interfaces at IBM, The Weather Company, Optum, Washington Mutual, and Intuit, from enterprise weather intelligence to healthcare and consumer banking products used by millions. A force multiplier for teams: pattern libraries, tooling, and accessibility practice that make other developers faster, now extended into AI-assisted workflows with MCP servers and Claude API integrations.

Core Competencies

Front-End Architecture: Component Architecture & Pattern Libraries · Design Systems Governance · Modernization & Migration · UI Performance
Accessibility: WCAG 2.1, Section 508, ARIA
Frameworks & Languages: React, Next.js, Svelte · JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS/Sass
Tooling & Testing: Storybook, Vite, Jest/RTL, Playwright, Figma
AI Workflow: MCP servers, Claude API, Local LLMs, Python

Professional Experience

IBM CONSULTING - SENIOR FRONT-END DEVELOPER **2021 – 2026**

Lead front-end engineer and architect across government and enterprise modernization programs, prototyped and built green-field zero-to-1 solutions for clients.

- Architected scalable React and Svelte applications for large enterprise clients, balancing performance, maintainability, and design system fidelity. Shipped portals to connect citizens in need with public services for various municipalities.
- Led accessibility strategy across multiple engagements, driving WCAG 2.1 / Section 508 compliance and coaching teams on ARIA patterns and semantic structure.
- Built and shipped production MCP servers for knowledge management and workflow automation, and developed AI-assisted workflows with the Claude API and Playwright.
- Stack: JavaScript, TypeScript, CSS, React, Svelte, MCP/Claude API, Playwright

IBM SOFTWARE / THE WEATHER COMPANY - SENIOR FRONT-END ENGINEER **2017 – 2021**

Product-focused front-end engineer on enterprise weather intelligence tools used by utilities, emergency managers, and commercial customers.

- Led front-end development of IBM Outage Prediction through an iterative, research-driven process: observed customer workflows, shipped fast on feedback, and cut time-to-decision for weather event response.
- Designed and built a historical storm-analog feature that surfaces the most similar past events alongside each forecast; it became one of the product's most-used features.
- Stack: JavaScript, Sass, React, Redux-Saga, IBM Carbon Design System

OPTUM / UNITED HEALTH GROUP - SENIOR FRONT-END DEVELOPER **2014 – 2017**

Front-end lead for enterprise healthcare applications serving millions of members and thousands of providers.

- Built consumer tools that helped members find, vet, and select healthcare plans and services, where clarity and accessibility shaped real healthcare decisions.
- Researched and designed a provider data-management portal around its power users, data-entry specialists who thought in spreadsheets. Delivered keyboard-driven navigation, enter-to-save, and inline numeric inputs in place of select lists, reducing friction.
- Stack: HTML, CSS, Sass, Angular 1, Adobe Experience Manager

SQUAREDESIGN - UI ENGINEER AND CMS CONSULTANT **2007 – 2014**

Independent front-end consultant and go-to specialist for technically demanding HTML, CSS, and animation work, with repeat subcontracts across multiple agency partners.

- Built and shipped Evernote's in-app announcements system end to end: WordPress authoring layer for their editorial team, filtering to target articles by language, region, product, and subscription, and embedded webview UI delivered to millions of users in Evernote's client apps.
- Developed reusable component libraries and custom CMS implementations for agency clients including Sony, Fidelity, Monster.com, Philips, Kronos, and Harvard Pilgrim, and built SpringPad's consumer marketing site.

WASHINGTON MUTUAL - SENIOR UI DEVELOPER **2002 – 2007**

Front-end specialist and accessibility lead for consumer banking applications serving millions of customers.

- Partnered with designers and UX researchers to build a pattern library of accessible, reusable UI components, defining the HTML/CSS layer in collaboration with design and ASP.NET engineering.
- Championed accessibility for years, identifying WCAG and Section 508 issues and driving fixes. When accessibility became a legal and compliance priority, became the organization's accessibility subject matter expert.

INTUIT - FRONT-END ENGINEER, USER-CENTERED DESIGN (UCD) **2000 – 2001**

Front-end development of QuickBooks Site Solutions, a website builder embedded in QuickBooks, through a full iterative cycle from sketches to tested production code.

Projects

- **AppendX** (iOS App Store & appendx.to): native SwiftUI app that captures text and URLs to your markdown files.
- **Markdown Vault MCP** (github.com/mikesusz/markdown-vault-mcp): open-source MCP server that gives AI assistants fine-grained access to a markdown vault.

Education

Wentworth Institute of Technology – studies in Architecture, Industrial and Graphic design (4 years)
Edmonds Community College – Business Administration coursework
Recent Training – JavaScript: The Hard Parts (Frontend Masters, 2026), Redux Fundamentals (Frontend Masters – in progress), MCP Mastery (Udemy, 2026), LLMs Mastery (Udemy, 2025), The Python Bible (Udemy, 2025)